MIL-C-44068B
14 October 1988
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-44068A
30 September 1983

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHEESE SPREAD, CHEDDAR; PEANUT BUTTER; AND JELLY, FOR MFAL READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers spreads in flexible bags for use as a component of meal, ready-to-eat, individual.

1.2 Classification. The spreads shall be of the following kinds as specified (see 6.1).

Kinds	
I	Cheese spread, cheddar
II	Peanut butter
III	Jelly, apple and grape

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8930

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-20078	- Jelly, Fruit
L-P-378	- Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
QQ-A-1876	- Aluminum Foil
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-C-595	- Cheese Spread, Cheddar

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595	- Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Fruit Jellies
U.S. Standards for Grades of Peanut Butter

(Copies may be obtained from the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0709, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC, 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese

(Copies may be obtained from Dairy Standardization Section, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2750, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

(Copies of drawings, publications, and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Copies should be obtained from the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Copies should be obtained from the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knot Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCE

Food Chemicals Codex

(Copies should be obtained from the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting

(Copies should be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Cheese spread, cheddar (kind I). The cheese spread shall comply with the ingredients and formulation requirements of class 1 (plain) of MIL-C-595, utilizing U.S. Grade A or better cheddar cheese (except for appearance), and shall meet the medium cured requirements of U.S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese. The finished appearance shall be U.S. Grade B or better for medium cured cheddar cheese of U.S. Standards for Grades of Cheddar Cheese. At time of use, the cheese shall have been properly trimmed, cleaned and free from mold, rind, and other extraneous matter. The cheese shall be uncolored and fortified by adding to each 1.5 ounces the following nutrients:

Vitamin A Concentrate or ester (palmitate) refined to be odorless and flavorless	2500 IU
Ascorbic acid 1/	38 mg
Pyridoxine 1/	1.0 mg
Thiamin 1/	0.80 mg

1/ Ingredient shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.1 Plastic cream. The plastic cream used to prepare cheddar cheese spread shall originate from Manufacturing Grade or/and Grade A milk and shall contain 75% milkfat. The product shall be pasteurized, sweet, have a pleasing flavor, and be free of objectionable flavors.

3.2.2 Peanut butter (kind II). The peanut butter shall possess a smooth texture, be stabilized, be regular pack style and be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Peanut Butter. The peanut butter shall be fortified to contain an average of not less than 2500 IU of Vitamin A, 1.1 mg pyridoxine hydrochloride, 0.8 mg thiamine hydrochloride and 37.5 mg ascorbic acid per 1.5 avoirdupois ounces of peanut butter. The peanut butter shall be aflatoxin negative when tested in accordance with approved FDA methods by the Food Safety and Quality Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.

3.2.3 Jelly (kind III). The jelly shall have the salient characteristics for apple and grape jelly in A-A-20078. The jelly shall also be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Fruit Jelly.

3.3 Filling and processing.

3.3.1 Cheese spread (kind I). The cheese spread shall be thermally processed in accordance with 21 CFR 113 - Thermally Processed Low-Acid Foods Packaged in Hermetically Sealed Containers and hot-filled in such a manner as to produce a commercially sterile product.

3.3.2 Peanut butter (kind II). Peanut butter, after processing, shall be cooled and filled at not more than 120°F.

3.3.3 Jelly (kind III). The jelly shall be processed and filled in such a manner as to produce a commercially sterile product, i.e., insuring that all interior surfaces of the hermetically sealed unit pack are exposed to a temperature of 160°F for 60 seconds or any equivalent treatment such as 170°F for 6 seconds, 180°F for 0.6 seconds, or by post-fill processing (i.e., pasteurization).

3.3.4 Filled bag cooling temperature requirement. The filled sealed bags of kinds I, II and III products shall be water cooled, air cooled, or combination of both sufficiently to insure the product temperature at the center of the bag shall be below 100°F prior to packing. If water cooling, is utilized, the bags shall be thoroughly dry before packing.

3.4 Finished product.

3.4.1 Cheese spread (kind I) requirements. The finished product, after the bag of product has been kneaded, shall have a smooth homogeneous appearance with no evidence of mottling, browning, oiling off or curdling. The product shall be spreadable at 70°F, be free from grainy (sandy) mouth-feel, and possess the flavor and aroma of medium cured cheddar cheese. The finished

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance and shall comply with the class 1 finished product requirements of MIL-C-595 as noted in 3.2.1.

3.4.2 Peanut butter (kind II) requirements. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.4.3 Jelly (kind III) requirements. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.5 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21, Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Processing, Packaging or Holding of Human Foods" and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government Inspection agency.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all the requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.1.2 Bag material certification. Material listed below shall be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of conformance to the indicated requirements.

Material requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedures
Polyolefin film	5.1.1	As specified in L-P-378, except that a machinist's micrometer may be used provided that its graduations and accuracy conform to the requirements of L-P-378.
Polyester film thickness	5.1.1	As above
Aluminum foil thickness	5.1.1	As specified in QQ-A-1876
Laminated material construction	5.1.1	Laboratory evaluation
Color of laminated material	5.1.1	Visual evaluation

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to preparation, processing, holding, bag filling, and bag closing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.3 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed bags shall be determined by separately weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with an average representative of empty bags. Any individual sample unit having a net weight of less than 1.4 ounces for kinds I and II, or less than 0.9 ounce for a kind III shall be classified as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 1.5 ounces for kinds I and II, or 1.0 ounce for kind III.

4.5.4 Filled and sealed bag examination. The filled and sealed bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in defects per hundred units, shall be 0.065 for critical defects, 1.5 for major defects, and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE I. Filled and sealed bag defects 1/

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
1			Tear, hole, or open seal
2			Swollen bag
3			Aberrations in bag material or heat seals resulting from heat sealing, bag fabrication, hot filling or heat processing that results in bag failure 2/
	101		Bag material not as specified
	102		Bag dimensions not as specified
	103		Width of seals not as specified
	104		Bag not heat sealed as specified
	105		Exterior color of bag not as specified
	106		Inside bag dimensions not as specified
	107		Closure seal not located as specified
	108		Closure or top seal extends into or below tear notch location

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Filled and sealed bag defects 1/ (cont'd)

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
	109		Not clean 3/
	110		Bag has foreign odor
	111		Required labeling missing, incorrect, illegible, or that smudges
	112		Embossed code marking not located as specified
	113		Distance between inside edge of tear notch or serrations and inside edge of seal is less than 3/16 inch
		201	Tear notch or serrations missing
		202	Tear notch or serrations not located as specified
		203	Depth of tear notch or serrations not as specified
		204	Excess bag material at edges exceeds 3/16 inch.

1/ Any evidence of insect or rodent infestation shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Aberrations in bag material or heat seals include:

a. Major fold-over wrinkles or severe wrinkles, that extend into heat seal area and reduce effective seal width to less than 1/16 inch; or

b. Severe wrinkles in the body of the bag along the inside edges of the heat seals.

Bags exhibiting one or more of these aberrations shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.7.1. Any bag failing the test shall be scored as a defect.

3/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause pouch damage (i.e. glass, metal filings, etc.) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the package. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential pouch damage and which can be readily removed by gently shaking the package or by gently brushing the package with a clean dry cloth.

b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one pouch face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

d. Very thin film of grease, oil, or product residue which is discernible to touch, but is not readily discernible by visual examination.

4.5.5 Product examination.

4.5.5.1 Kind I. The kind I product shall be examined for the defects indicated in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

TABLE II. Product examination 1/ 2/ 3/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Not a smooth, homogeneous appearance, with evidence of mottling or browning.
152	Evidence of oiling off or curdling.
153	Not spreadable at 70°F.
154	Evidence of grainy (sandy) texture (mouth-feel).

1/ Knead bags of kind I before opening for examination.

2/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or discoloration shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.5.2 Kinds II and III. The kinds II and III products shall be inspected as follows: The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed bag. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by inspection level S-3. The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or discoloration shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Any product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

4.5.6 Bag leakage and delamination inspection. All exterior surfaces and edges of the filled and sealed bag shall be examined visually for product leakage while applying a manual kneading action which forces the product against the interior bag surface in the area being observed. The bag shall then be examined for evidence of delamination. Any product leakage from the bag or evidence of delamination of the bag shall be considered a major defect except delamination of the outer ply when located in the seam area 1/16 inch or further from the food product edge of seal. Bags exhibiting this type of delamination shall be tested by manually flexing the delaminated area 10 times. The area of delamination shall be held between the thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delamination area shall then be rapidly flexed by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise - counterclockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delamination area near the tear notches to avoid tearing the bag material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between the thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal. If the separated area is too small to be held between thumb and forefinger, a number two stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and a gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend to less than 1/16 inch from the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistance to the gentle lifting, the bag shall be rejected. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

4.5.7 Bag closure seal testing. The filled and sealed bags shall be tested in accordance with method A or B of ASTM D 882, except that the testing speed may be 10 to 12 inches per minute. For preformed bags, three adjacent specimens, 1/2 or 1 inch wide, shall be cut from the closure seal of each bag in the sample. For the form-fill-seal bags, three adjacent specimens, 1/2 or 1 inch wide shall be cut from each side and each end of each bag in the sample. For the preformed bag, the average seal strength of the closure seal shall be calculated by averaging the test results of the three test specimens cut from that seal. For the form-fill-seal bag, the average seal strength of each side and end of the bag shall be calculated by averaging the test results of the three specimens cut from that side or end. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. The lot size shall be expressed in bags.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5. Any test specimen or average seal strength failing to meet the requirements of 5.1.1 shall be scored as a major defect.

4.5.7.1 Internal pressure test for samples with aberrations (table I, see 2/). Internal pressure resistance shall be determined by pressurizing the bags while they are restrained between two rigid plates spaced 1/2 ± 1/16 inch apart. For testing preformed bags, the bottom seal shall be cut off. For testing form-fill-seal bags, the end seal with the least evidence of aberrations shall be cut off. The bags shall be emptied and cleaned thoroughly with a mild detergent and water solution prior to testing. Pressure shall be applied at the approximate uniform rate of 1 psig per second until 17 psig pressure is reached. The 17 psig pressure shall be held constant for 30 seconds and then released. The bags shall then be examined for separation or yield of the heat seals. Any rupture or evidence of seal separation greater than 1/16 inch, or seal separation that reduces the effective closure width to less than 1/16 inch shall be considered a test failure.

4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Pads and cells missing or not as specified.
Average number of bags per box in any given lot is less than the number marked on the box exterior.

Minor: Cells not positioned as specified.
Bags not evenly stacked flat in cells.

4.5.9 Intermediate carton examination. The intermediate paperboard carton shall be examined for defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in cartons. The sample units shall be one filled and sealed intermediate paperboard carton. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5 for minor defects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Intermediate carton defects.

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Bulged carton.
202	Not closed in the manner specified.
203	Required labeling or marking missing, incorrect, or illegible.
204	Carton not fully closed or damaged.
205	Number of envelopes less than required.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A.

5.1.1 Level A. The product, in net weights as specified below, shall be filled in a bag formed by heat sealing to the size and design configuration as shown on figure 1:

Product	Net weight (minimum)
Cheese spread	1.5 ounces
Peanut butter	1.5 ounces
Jelly	1.0 ounce

The bag material shall be a 3-ply laminate consisting of 0.002 inch (minimum) thick polyolefin, extrusion coated or laminated to 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil, laminated to 0.0005 inch thick polyester. The three plies shall be laminated so that the aluminum foil is between the other two layers. The color of the exterior (polyester) side of the laminate shall conform to numbers 30045, 30099, 30108, 30111, 30117, 30118, 34052, 34064, 34079, 34086 or 34087 of FED-STD-595. Any difference in gloss caused by the exterior layer will be considered acceptable. The polyolefin layer of bag material shall be suitably formulated for hot filling or post-fill processing as applicable (see 3.3). Alternatively, if the bag has serrated edges, the serrations may be used as tear notches provided that the serrations are sharp (no plastic tailings exist) and the serration depth and the minimum seal width at the serrated edges are in accordance with the dimensions shown on figure 1. Excess bag material at the edges of the bag shall not exceed 3/16 inch. The product shall be hot filled into the bag or heat processed after filling and closing (see 3.3). Closure shall be accomplished with a 3/8 $\pm$ 1/8 inch wide heat seal. If thermal impulse or a combination (heat curved bar with thermal impulse) sealing is used, any

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

seal width from 1/8 to 7/16 inch will be acceptable. The closure seal shall be located in accordance with figure 1. The bag shall show no aberration in the bag material or heat seals. Filled and sealed bags showing aberrations shall withstand a minimum internal pressure of 17 psig. when tested in accordance with 4.5.7.1 to verify package integrity. The average seal strength of each seal shall be not less than 6 pounds per linear inch, and no individual test specimen shall be less than 5 pounds when tested not less than 24 hours after processing (hot-fill or post-fill processing) in accordance with 4.5.7. The filled and sealed bags shall not leak or show evidence of delamination when examined in accordance with 4.5.6. The bag material shall not transfer any foreign flavor or odor to the product being packaged.

5.1.1.1 Intermediate box. When specified, eighteen 1.5 ounce (42.5g) bags of kind II or eighteen 1 ounce (28.35g) bags of kind III, unit packed as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in an intermediate folding paperboard box conforming to style III, VIII or XI A, type C, class i of PPP-B-566. The paperboard shall be minimum 0.022 inches thick. The box for kind II shall be 6-7/8 inches in length, 4-7/8 inches in width, and 3 inches in depth. The box for kind III shall be 6-7/8 inches in length, 4-7/8 inches in width, and 2 inches in depth.

5.2 Level C packing.

5.2.1 For shipment to ration assembler for Meal, Ready-to-Eat. Up to 300 (± 2 percent) filled and sealed bags of kind I or kind II product or up to 400 (± 2 percent) filled and sealed bags of kind III product shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, type CF (variety SW), class domestic, grade 175 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each box shall be fitted with individual cells and top and bottom pads fabricated of the same material as the box. Each cell shall be made from a single sheet of fiberboard scored and folded to form 4 walls having a height equal to the inside height of the box less the thickness of the top and bottom pads. The flutes of the fiberboard in the cell walls shall be in the same direction as the flutes of the box sides and end panels. The top and bottom pad dimensions shall be equal to the inside length and width of the box less 1/4 inch. For boxes containing up to 300 bags of kind I or II product, each box shall be fitted with three individual cells, positioned three in length, one in width and one in depth. For boxes containing more than 300 bags of kind III product, each box shall be fitted with four cells, positioned four in length, one in width and one in depth. The bags shall be evenly stacked flat within each cell. The number of bags per cell shall approximate the number marked on the box exterior divided by the number of cells in the box.

5.2.2 For shipment to ration assembler for Tray Pack Meal Module. Twenty intermediate boxes of one type only shall be packed in a fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, type CF, class domestic, grade 175 of PPP-B-636.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Bags. Each bag shall bear lot identification information presented in the sequence listed below:

Date of pack (using 4 digit code beginning with the final digit of the current year and followed by the 3 digit Julian date)	
Lot number (if different from Date of pack)	
Batch Code Production Shift Filling equipment identification	As applicable, specified in a code approved by the USDA Inspector

When embossed coding is used, the code shall be located in one of the heat seals. There shall be a continuous seal path between the embossed code and the inside edge of the side seal that is detectable by visual examination. Additionally, each bag shall contain the following information, as applicable, clearly printed with permanent ink in large black letters:

CHEESE SPREAD

KNEAD PACKAGE BEFORE OPENING

NAME AND ADDRESS OF PRODUCER

PEANUT BUTTER

KNEAD PACKAGE BEFORE OPENING

NAME AND ADDRESS OF PRODUCER

APPLE JELLY

GRAPE JELLY

NAME AND ADDRESS OF PRODUCER

In addition, the following information shall be printed on the face of each bag:

TO OPEN, TEAR OFF ONE CORNER OF BAG

5.3.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3.2.1 Intermediate boxes. Intermediate boxes shall be marked as follows (as applicable):

PEANUT BUTTER	APPLE JELLY	GRAPE JELLY
18 (1.5 oz. envelopes)	18 (1 oz. envelopes)	18 (1 oz. envelopes)

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Type, number, and date of this document.
b. Kind required (see 1.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.3).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.4.1, 3.4.2, 3.4.3, and 6.3).
e. When 1.5 ounces (42.5g) or 1 ounce (28.35g) bags are to be packed into intermediate cartons (see 5.1.2).

6.2 Award of contract. Award of contracts for the products specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions in 3.5.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Cheese spread
Jelly
Meal, Ready-to-Eat
Peanut butter
Ration

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

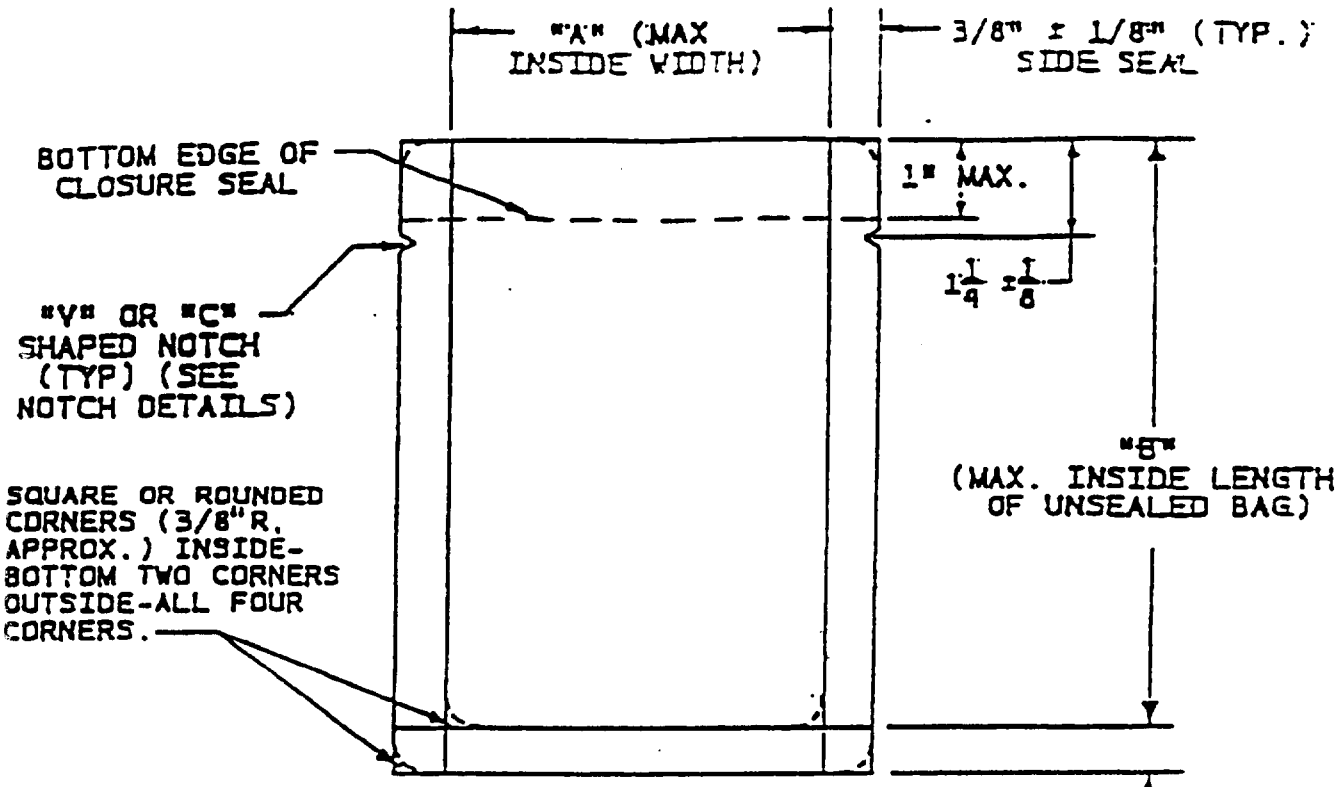
Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

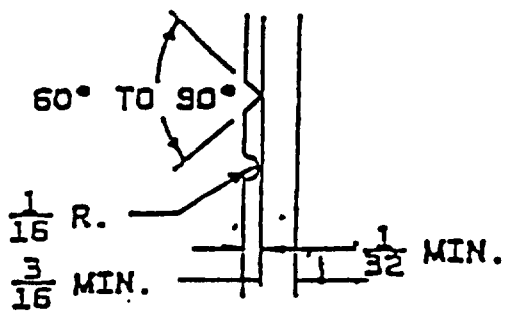
Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-0647

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.





NOTCH DETAILS

PRODUCT	BAG SIZE "A"	BAG SIZE "B"
CHEESE SPREAD CHEDDAR	2 13/16	5 5/16
PEANUT BUTTER	2 9/16	5 5/16
JELLY	2 5/16	5 5/16

FIGURE-1
FOUR SEAL BAG

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-44068B	Cheese Spread, Cheddar; Peanut Butter; and Jelly, For Meal, Ready-To-Eat

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

NATICK OP-1. Feb 86

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21123:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT
and ENGINEERING CENTER
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
U.S, Army Natick Research, Development
and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T23:41Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.